had asked me to send reports home about my experiences in Hollywood. After we finished *Sergeant Murphy*, I wrote: “No matter what anyone says or what the future may bring, now I can always insist that I once was an actor.

“If I’d only made one picture it might have been called a fluke. But I’ve made two now, and that makes me an actor—even if in name only.”

Four months later, *Love Is on the Air* was released and I raced around town searching for reviews of my first movie. For the most part, they were kind. The *Hollywood Reporter*, one of the most important trade papers, said *“Love Is on the Air* presents a new leading man, Ronald Reagan, who is a natural, giving one of the best first picture performances Hollywood has offered in many a day.”

A few days later, Warner Brothers picked up my option for another six months and gave me a raise.

I called Nelle and Jack and asked them to come to California. Within a few weeks, they were on their way. And in a way, I suppose I was too, although now I faced the same kind of problem I faced during my first year at Eureka College when Mac McKinzie relegated me to the fifth string of the football squad: I had made the team; now I had to make the first string.